Walking Scotland

Cambo Health Walks









Background Information

These walks have been developed by the Monday Walking Group which meets at the Cambo Stables each Monday morning at 9.30am, weather permitting.

The group walks are in association with Walking Scotland, a National Walking and Wheeling charity, whose purpose is to encourage walking by providing a framework for organised walking groups.

Walking Scotland use both terms walking and wheeling as it's more inclusive. Both words represent the action of moving at a pedestrian's pace, whether or not someone is unaided or using some kind of wheeled mobility aid.

The Walk Leaders have received appropriate training to ensure the walks are suitable and risk assessed for all attending, including those who use wheeled devices.

The walks are short, safe and social where the aim is to walk at a pace that we are able to talk.
They last approximately 1 → 1¼ hours and between 1 → 5km in length.

Depending on weather conditions, the paths may be slippery in places.

Cambo Gardens are managed by the Cambo Heritage Trust with its' simple aim for Cambo to be a place 'where people and plants grow'.

Walking Scotland

Woodland Circular Walk



Walking Scotland

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Woodland Circular Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading south past the car park and along a flat, narrow in places, woodland path towards the entrance to the estate. Crossing the main driveway, we head down a sloping path towards the Cambo Burn. Keeping the burn on our right we follow the path as it meanders through the Cambo Den. Take note of the interesting rock formations and tree root systems on the other side of the Den.

Continue along before crossing over a bridge* and taking the left fork thereby now having the burn on our left. As you walk along this section keep a lookout for the badger sett on the opposite bank of the burn.

*Note: some of the bridges only have handrails on the one side!

Just before the next bridge, we take a sharp right, up a fairly steep incline, through a gate, that brings us to the edge of the woodland.

We follow the path along the side of the field, past the compost bins, and re-enter the woodland where we continue down the path, keeping the burn on our left. Along this path we pass a fence with a gate, which is an ideal place for Strength & Balance exercises. Beyond this fence we come to a bridge where we cross over the burn and turn left in the direction of the stables.

Follow this path, keeping the burn to your left. Look out for the otter holt on the south bank of the burn.

Further along, with Cambo House on your right, the path reaches a wooden gate.

Through the gate, we turn right and the walk ends after we skirt round the north of the Walled Garden, through the Prairie Garden and back to the Stables Visitor Centre.

Pathway Conditions:

The gravel path is clear and wide enough for a wheeled walking aid. There are some inclines, both down and up, mainly on the return section, where extra care is necessary, particularly on the downward inclines.

Woodland Circular Walk

Weather Considerations:

In Autumn, the paths have a good covering of leaves that can be slippery when wet.

In winter, the path may be slippery in places during frosty weather but should remain mostly passable.

Interesting Features:

At the beginning of the walk, the features are typical woodland, with some interesting rock formations and tree root systems visible particularly through the Cambo Den.

Cambo Cottages Walk



Walking Scotland

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Cambo Cottages Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading south past the car park and along a flat woodland path towards the entrance to the estate where it takes a right turn and heads through woodland on the inside of the estate perimeter wall. There are a number of small boardwalks on this section where care should be taken, particularly if wet.

Walking through this part of the woodland there are fields to the right where roe deer can be seen crossing and grey herons are regular visitors, the nests of which are in the treetops above you.

Further along this path is an old Icehouse, previously used to store fresh meat, fish, fruit and ice throughout the year before mechanical refrigeration was invented. Beyond the icehouse the path undulates and narrows, due to the vegetation, where single file walking is required.

Near the end of this path, on the left-hand side, is a rope swing that was used by the legendary Annmarie Taggart on her Cambo Health Walks.

Leaving the woodland, through a gate, a right turn is made down past Cambo Farm to a T-junction where another right turn is made on to a hard-core surface with hedgerows on either side. Be aware that vehicles can use this to gain access to Cambo House.

Along this section are the tennis courts, that were originally a curling pond, alongside which is the Curling Hut where the curling stones were stored. The Curling Hut is open to view.

Continuing along, with Cambo House on the left, the road sweeps to the right and the walk ends under the chestnut tree at the entrance to the Stables Visitor Centre.

Cambo Cottages Walk

Pathway Conditions:

The gravel path at the start of the walk is clear and wide enough for a wheeled walking aid. Through the woodland, adjacent to the estate perimeter wall, the path has undulations and can be soft underfoot. Beyond the woodland, the path remains firm in most weathers.

Weather Considerations:

In winter, the path may be slippery in places during frosty weather however remains mostly passable.

Interesting Features:

Wildlife, icehouse, Cambo cottages, tennis courts, Cambo House.

Cambo Estate Walk



Walking Scotland

Cambo Estate Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading south past the car park and along a flat woodland path towards the entrance to the estate where it takes a right turn and heads through woodland on the inside of the estate perimeter wall. There are a number of small boardwalks on this section where care should be taken, particularly if wet.

Walking through this part of the woodland there are fields to the right where roe deer can be seen crossing and grey herons are regular visitors, the nests of which are in the treetops above you.

Further along this path is an old Icehouse, previously used to store fresh meat, fish, fruit and ice throughout the year before mechanical refrigeration was invented. Beyond the icehouse the path undulates and narrows, due to the vegetation, where single file walking is required. Further along, on the left-hand side, is a rope swing that was used by the legendary Annmarie Taggart on her Cambo Health Walks.

At the end of this path, exit through a wooden gate, go cross the road, and enter another woodland again through a wooden gate. Follow the single-file path along the left side of a mill pond and continue until a tarmac road is reached. This is the vehicle entrance road to Kingsbarns GC. Take a right and walk along the right hand side grass verge until the golf practice area is in view. Immediately before the practice area, take the path on the left, along the edge of the field with the woodland on your right. Keep going until you reach a tarmac road (Back Stile), where you turn right and it leads down to a car park.

Situated at one end of this car park is Harbour Burger (fast food & refreshments) and an area that can be used for Strength & Balance exercises.

Head to the far end of the car park, go through a kissing gate and follow the track between the beach and golf course; when the track curves away to the right, fork left on a grassy path (waymarker). Be aware of any golf being played and move along quietly.

Cambo Estate Walk

Before reaching a band of trees the route emerges onto a wider track; bear right along this, passing to the right of the wooden toilets. Beyond these the track enters the woods. Go through the Cambo gate ahead signed for Fife Coastal Path, note the bridge over the Cambo burn but do not cross this, instead turn right up path on the near bank.

Follow this path, keeping the burn to your left. Look out for the otter holt on the opposite bank of the burn.

Further along, with Cambo House on your right, the path reaches a wooden gate.

Through the gate, we turn right and the walk ends after we skirt round the north of the Walled Garden, through the Prairie Garden and back to the Stables Visitor Centre.

Pathway Conditions:

The gravel path at the start of the walk is clear and wide enough for a wheeled walking aid. Through the woodland, adjacent to the estate perimeter wall, the path has undulations and can be soft underfoot. From the woodland down to the Kingsbarns Beach Car Park, the path remains firm in most weathers.

Beyond the car park, the path is compacted sand and, therefore, prone to becoming soft in wet weather.

Again, on the woodland walk back to the Stables the path can be soft underfoot.

Weather Considerations:

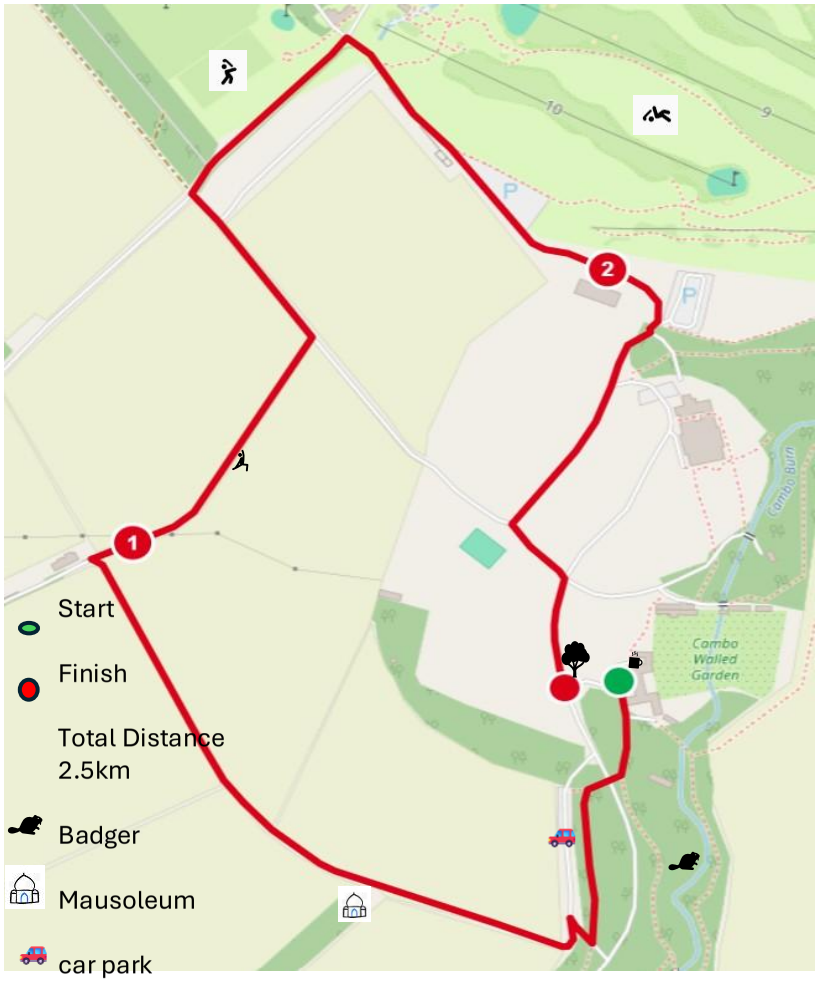
In Autumn, some of the paths have a good covering of leaves that can be slippery when wet.

In winter, the path may be slippery in places during frosty weather however remains mostly passable.

Interesting Features:

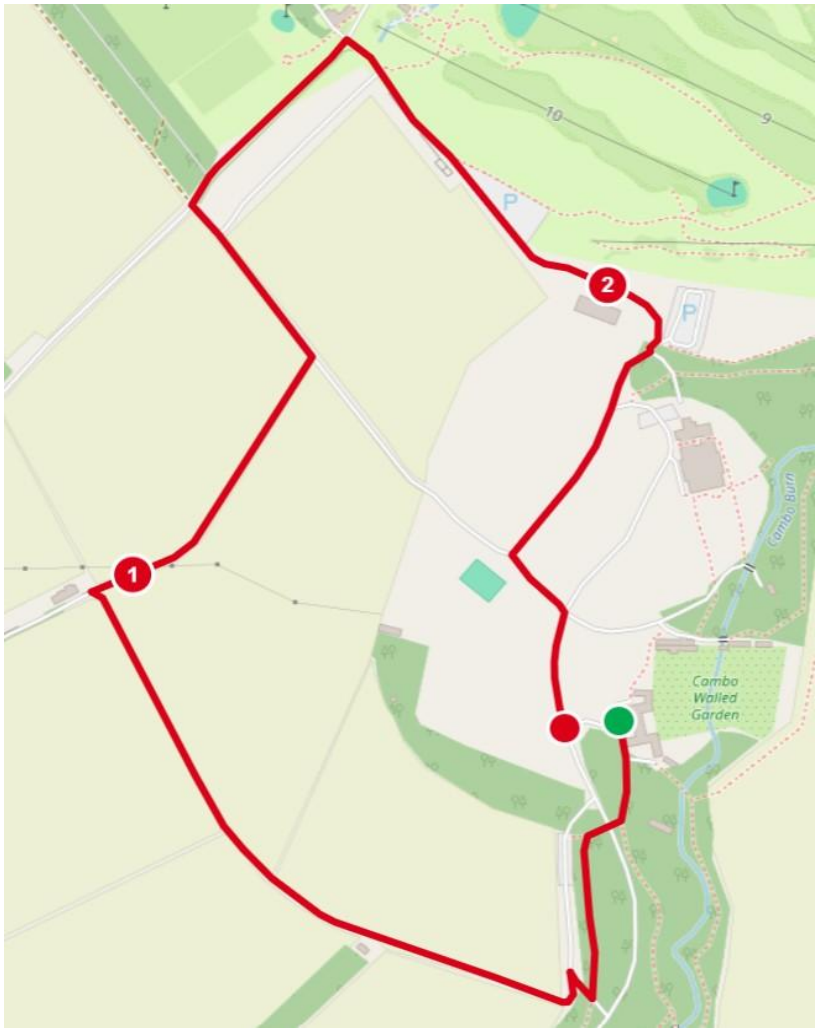
Wildlife, icehouse, Cambo Sands, golf course, Cambo House.

Cambo Mausoleum Walk



Walking Scotland

Mausoleum Walk





Mausoleum Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading south to the end of the car park then turn right onto a path made of large chips. Presently, this path is not suitable for any wheeled devices.

Approximately half-way along this path, the Mausoleum is on the left-hand side. Access can be gained most of the time unless a special event is taking place. The Mausoleum was built in 1821 as the burial chamber for the Erskine family.

Further along this path there are fields on both sides where roe deer can be seen crossing and grey herons are regular visitors. At the crossroads turn right, then left and right again on to a tarmac road taking you (quietly!) past the golf practice area. Just before the Clubhouse, turn right and, with the golf course on the left, head towards an Estate storage compound. Care should be taken passing through as this area contains items of machinery, logs, pallets etc.

After this compound turn right in the direction of Cambo House and follow the path keeping Cambo House on the left. Arriving at a T-junction, directly opposite are the tennis courts, that were originally a curling pond, alongside which is the Curling Hut where the curling stones were stored. The Curling Hut is open to view.

Turn left and with Cambo House on the left, the road sweeps to the right and the walk ends under the chestnut tree at the entrance to the Stables Visitor Centre.

Pathway Conditions:

The chipped path near the start of the walk, although wide enough, is not suitable for a wheeled walking aid. Throughout the remainder of the walk the path remains firm in most weathers.

Interesting Features:

Wildlife, Mausoleum, golf facility, tennis courts, Cambo House.

Hag Stones Walk



Start

Finish

Total Distance – 2.5km

steps (45)

Otter

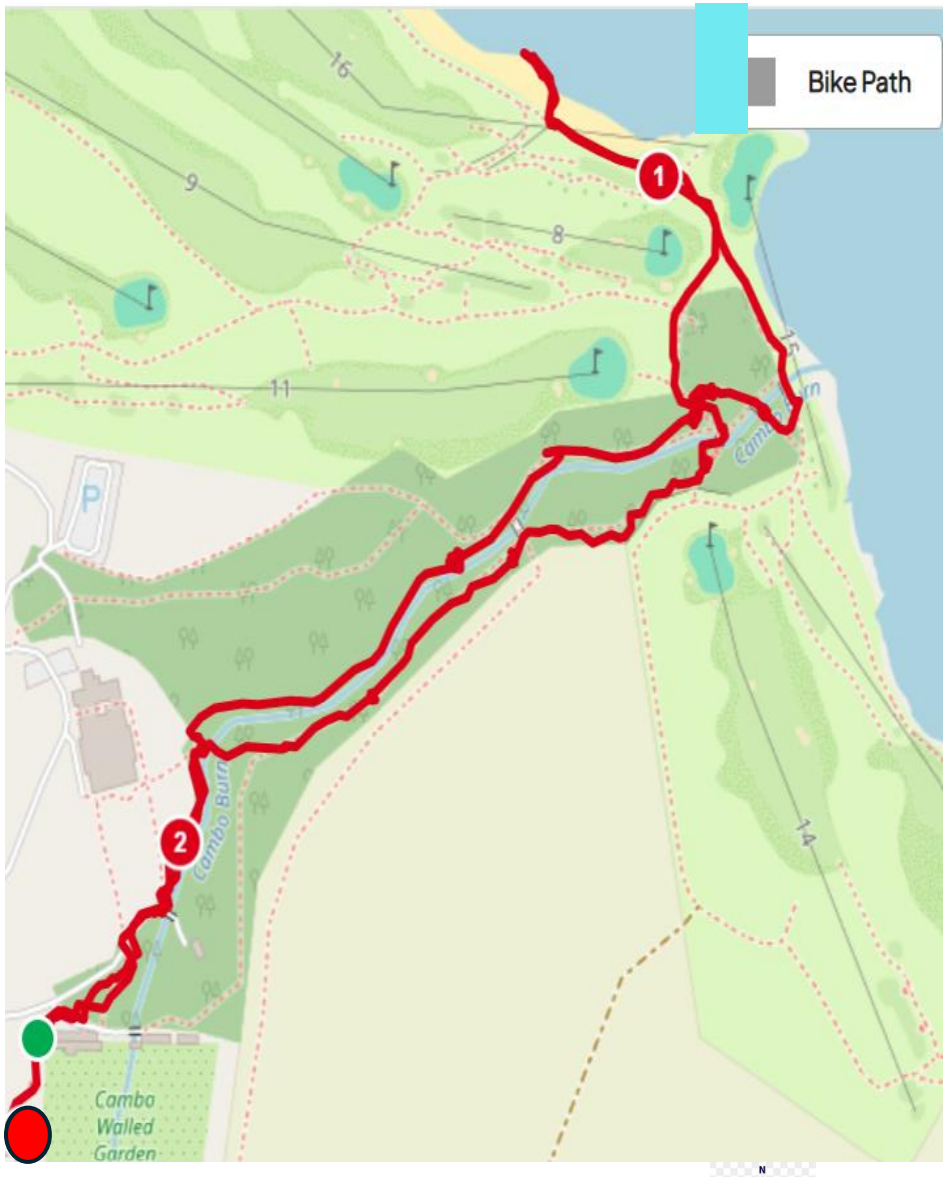
car park

exercise area

incline

refreshments

Hag Stones Walk



Hag Stones Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading north east, through the Prairie Garden keeping the Cambo Burn on the right we follow the path beyond Cambo House before crossing a bridge, through a wooden gate, then taking the left fork and continuing with the burn on our left.

The path steadily rises as we head towards the sea. Just beyond the crest of the path the 'Three Bridges' come into view followed by 45 steps that descend to the burn.

After crossing the first bridge and passing through the gate, turn right towards the second bridge and, after crossing, turn back across the third bridge. At this point be aware of any golfers playing the 15th hole of Kingsbarns GC. Head along the sandy path towards the Cambo Sands, where a small track leads down a small incline to the area containing Hag Stones.

Returning from the beach, via the small track, take a left turn along the sandy path before reaching a band of trees. The route emerges onto a wider track; bear right along this, passing to the right of the wooden toilets. Beyond these the track enters the woods. Go through the Cambo gate ahead signed for Fife Coastal Path, note the bridge over the Cambo burn but do not cross this, instead turning right up path on the near bank.

Follow this path, keeping the burn to your left, until, with Cambo House on your right, the path reaches a wooden gate.

Turning right the walk ends after we skirt round the north of the Walled Garden, through the Prairie Garden and back around to the Visitor Centre.

Pathway Conditions:

The path is clear and wide enough for a wheeled walking aid. There are some inclines, both down and up, mainly on the outward section, where extra care is necessary, particularly on the downward inclines.

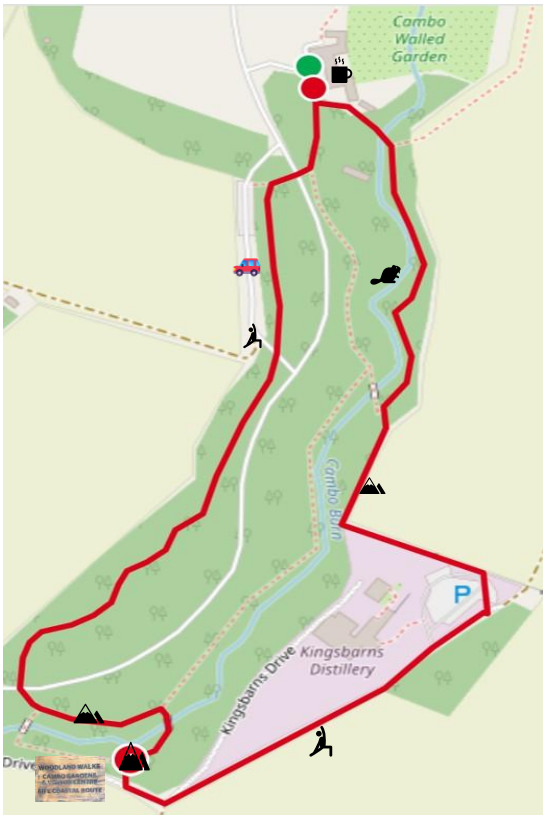
Weather Considerations:

Depending on weather conditions the path may be slippery in places.

Interesting Features:

Hag stones, golf course, look out for the otter holt on the south bank of the burn.

Distillery Walk



Walking Scotland

Start

Finish

Total Distance – 1.83km

Badger

refreshments

car park

exercise area

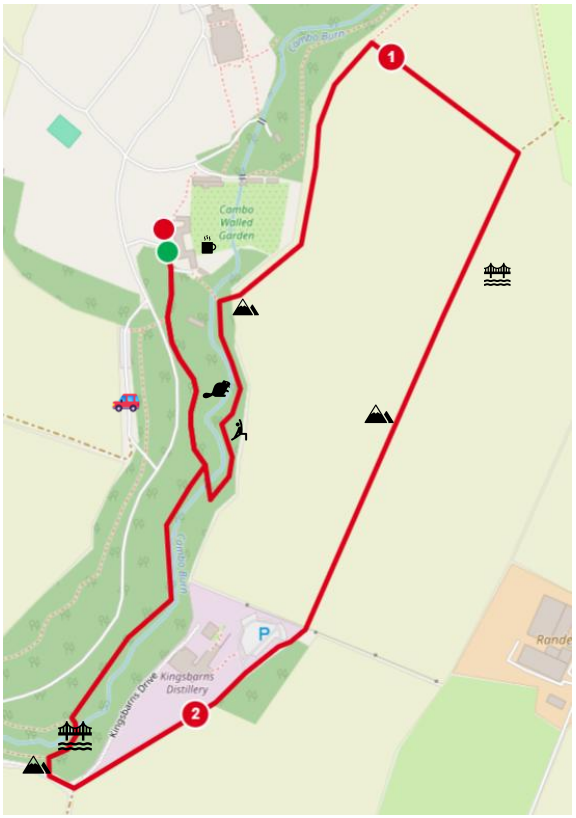
incline

Distillery Walk



Distillery Walk

Cambo Circular Walk



Start

Finish

Total Distance – 2.97km

Badger

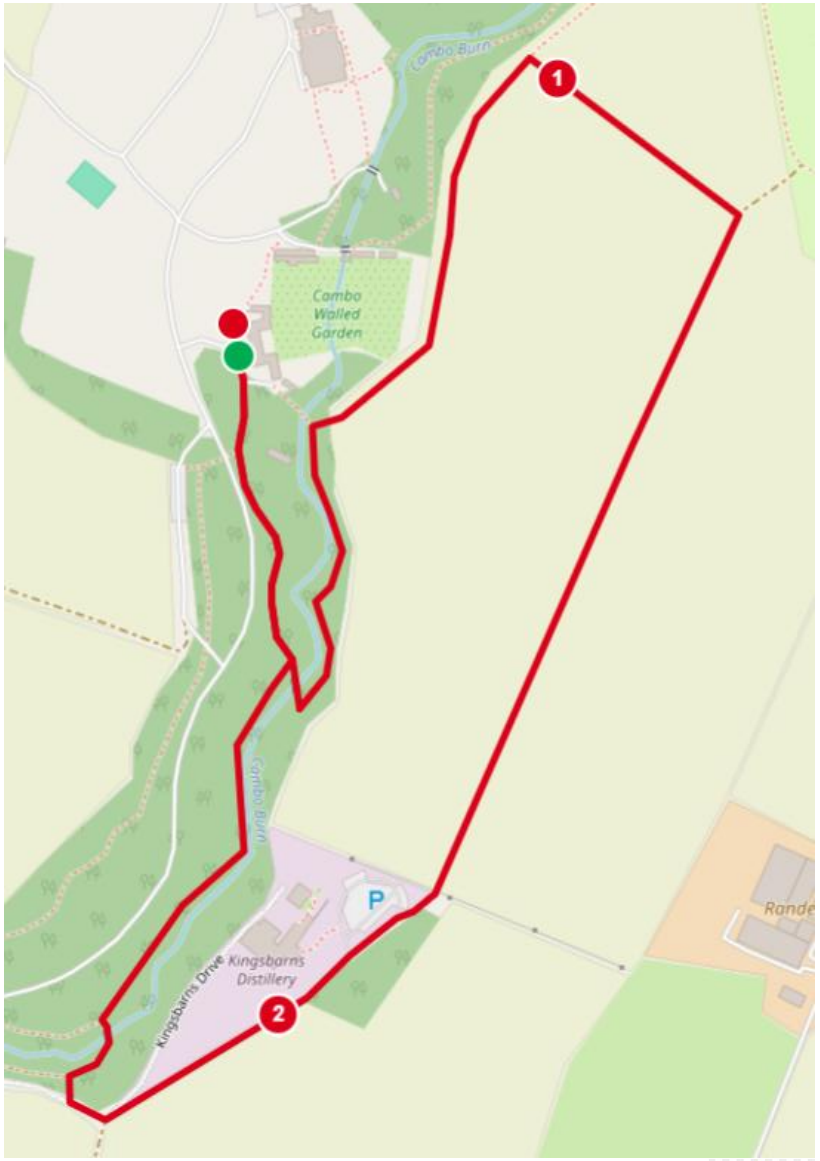
refreshments

car park

exercise area

incline

Cambo Circular Walk



Cambo Circular Walk

Cambo Walled Garden Walk



Start

Finish

Total Distance – 1.5km

Refreshments

Incline

Chestnut tree



Walking Scotland

Cambo Walled Garden Walk





Cambo Walled Garden Walk

Walk Leader Agreement

*We will always try to make the walk safe for you by doing a risk assessment

*We will describe the route and any hazards to you before we start walking and will let you decide how far you want to walk

*We will try to make sure that all staff and volunteers have done the Walking Scotland Walk Leader training course

*We will try to find a walk that is suitable for everyone

Walking Scotland

Walking Scotland use both terms walking and wheeling as it's more inclusive. Both words represent the action of moving at a pedestrian's pace, whether or not someone is unaided or using some kind of wheeled mobility aid.

Walker Agreement

* I will only do the walk if I am fit enough. If I have any concerns about this I will talk to a Walk Leader or a health professional

* I will tell a Walk Leader if I feel unwell while out on a walk

* I will let a Walk Leader know if I am leaving the walk before it has ended

* It is up to me to make sure I can do the Health Walk safely

* I understand that I come on a Health Walk at my own risk

Walking Scotland

Walking Scotland use both terms walking and wheeling as it's more inclusive. Both words represent the action of moving at a pedestrian's pace, whether or not someone is unaided or using some kind of wheeled mobility aid.

Strength & Balance

1 THE BACK KNEE STRENGTHENER:

Do this one standing in front of a bench or table.

Stand up tall and bend one knee, bringing your foot **slowly** towards your bottom Hold for a low count of 3. Keep the knee of the bent leg slightly behind the knee of the straight leg

Return to the starting position slowly.

Again, try this 5 times on each side at first and build up to 10 times with each leg.



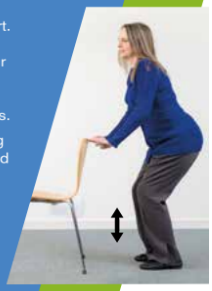
2 KNEE BENDS:

Stand facing the bench or table as before.

Place your feet shoulder width apart. Bend your knees and squat down by about 10cm (4") by bending your knees. Come up and repeat. Keep your back straight and don't let your knees extend over your toes.

This exercise will strengthen the big muscles in your hips and thighs, and will improve your balance. This can help when climbing stairs, walking, or bending to speak to someone.

Try this exercise 5 times and build up to 10 repetitions as you get stronger. You could also hold the squat for a few seconds.



3 CALF RAISES WITH SUPPORT:

Stand facing the bench or table as before.

Hold on and look straight ahead.

Position your feet hip width apart. Slowly and with control come up onto your toes, hold for a slow count of 3 and lower your heels back down.

Repeat this exercise 5 times, building up to 10 or more. As your balance improves, try holding on with just one hand or fingertips.

This exercise strengthens your calf muscles and toe joints. It helps you manage everyday activities such as hanging out washing, or reaching up into high cupboards.



4 TOE RAISES WITH SUPPORT:

Stand tall beside a bench or table.

Hold on and look ahead. Your feet should be hip width apart. Come back onto your heels, raising the front of your feet off the floor, then lower your toes back to the ground. Don't let your body hinge at the hips, keep the body as straight as possible.

Repeat this exercise 5 times and build up to 10 or more. As your balance improves, try holding on with just one hand or fingertips.

This strengthens your lower leg muscles and will make it easier for you to step backwards, or do fun things like push your grandchildren on the swings!



5 SIDE HIP STRENGTHENER:

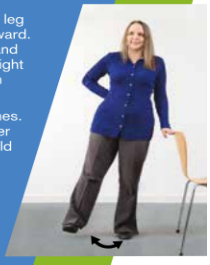
Stand tall beside a bench or table.

Hold on and keep your exercising leg straight, with the foot straight forward. Slowly lift the leg out to the side and return. Try and keep the body upright and only move the leg, rather than swinging over to the side.

Repeat 5 times, build up to 10 times. Swap round and exercise the other leg. Lift the leg out to the side, hold for a slow count of 3 and return.

Try to keep the body upright and only move the leg, rather than the top part of your body.

This strengthens your hip muscles and helps you with stepping up over pavements or kerbs.



6 SIDEWAYS WALKING:

Stand up tall and place your hands on your hips.

Use a support in front of you if needed such as a wall or railing. Take 10 steps to the right, pause and then take 10 steps to the left.

This exercise is good for moving in a sideways direction, for example stepping out of the way on a pavement to allow someone past.

TAKE CARE



Walking Scotland